

Lab 10 — Frontier Agents Decision Sprint

Participant workbook | Project Nova Phase 2 | 70-90 minutes

LAB OUTCOME

Build an evidence-controlled chain from business question to approved management output. You will test Researcher, Analyst, Word/PowerPoint agents and optional Cowork without treating the chain as automatically trustworthy.

The case

Project Nova must choose a controlled three-application pilot, a five-application rollout, or more discovery. Technical readiness and business coverage point in different directions.

Known fact	Value
Applications in scope	5
Technically ready applications	3
Ready-app request volume	46 of 120 (38.3%)
Not-ready app volume	74 of 120 (61.7%)
One-business-day target	Proposed — not approved

Choose your path

Path	Use when	Method
A — Full Frontier	Researcher, Analyst and Office agents are available	Complete the full agent chain
B — Partial availability	Only some agents are visible	Use available agent; complete gaps with in-app Copilot
C — Standard Copilot	Frontier is unavailable	Use Copilot Chat + Copilot in Excel, Word and PowerPoint

Exercise 1 — Capability and source check

- Open Microsoft 365 Copilot and record which capabilities are visible.
- Download the Decision Brief, Options Source Pack, Dataset, KPI Rules, TRUST template and Evaluation workbook.
- Use only synthetic workshop files.
- State which source is authoritative for constraints and which source contains calculated evidence.

Checkpoint

STOP AND VERIFY

Can every participant name the chosen path and explain why the source pack outranks a plausible external claim?

Exercise 2 — Researcher

Attach or reference the approved Decision Brief and Options Source Pack. Ask Researcher to compare all three options. Require claim-level citations, source ranking, explicit uncertainty and the decision questions that remain for the committee.

RESEARCHER PROMPT

Investigate the three Project Nova Phase 2 rollout options using the supplied Decision Brief and Options Source Pack as the authoritative internal sources. You may add current external context, but label it separately and do not override named internal constraints. For every material claim, cite the source. Separate confirmed facts, calculated findings, assumptions, conflicts and decisions required. Do not select or approve the final option.

Exercise 3 – Analyst

Open the Access Request Dataset. Profile it before calculating KPIs. Require a duplicate check, invalid or missing values, definition conflicts, exclusions and denominators.

ANALYST PROMPT

Profile this workbook before calculating any KPI. Identify duplicates, invalid values, missing values, classification conflicts and inconsistent definitions. Then calculate request volume by application and the share covered by technically ready applications. Explain every exclusion and denominator. Treat the one-business-day threshold as Proposed, not Approved. Create editable tables and charts in the workbook.

Expected comparison

Researcher may conclude	Analyst may conclude	Human interpretation
A three-app pilot is technically feasible.	The same three apps cover only 38.3% of observed volume.	Both statements can be correct; the committee decides whether limited coverage is acceptable.

Exercise 4 — TRUST handoff

Do not send raw Researcher or Analyst output straight to an Office agent. Complete the TRUST template and release only when the evidence is controlled.

TRUST check	Question
Trace	Can every material claim be linked to a precise source?
Rank	Are approved, operational, draft and external sources distinguished?
Uncertainty	Are conflicts, assumptions and missing values explicit?
Sign-off	Has a human approved what may be transferred?
Transfer	Is the next agent's permitted scope and decision boundary clear?

Exercise 5 — Create management outputs

- Give the approved handoff to Word Agent or Copilot in Word. Ask for a two-to-three-page decision paper.
- Review the paper. Correct status labels, citations, conditions and the decision owner.
- Give only the approved paper and source map to PowerPoint Agent or Copilot in PowerPoint. Ask for a six-slide steering deck.
- Compare all figures with the Excel workbook.

DIRECT CREATION RULE

Where the agent can create or update the Word document, workbook or presentation directly, use that supported action. Do not manually retype generated tables or figures.

Exercise 6 — Optional Cowork

Use Cowork only after the committee-approved action list exists. Ask it to prepare the actions, owners and next-step plan, then stop before any consequential approval or external action.

COWORK PROMPT

Using only the approved Project Nova decisions and actions, prepare a follow-up plan with action, owner, due date, source decision and approval status. Do not send messages, change systems, create commitments or execute consequential actions. Stop and show me the approval boundary.

Final verification

- The decision paper and deck use 46 of 120 (38.3%) for ready-app coverage.
- FinanceHub and Power BI constraints remain visible.
- The one-business-day target remains Proposed unless a human approves it.
- Data-quality exclusions and mixed definitions are disclosed.
- No agent is described as approving the rollout.
- Every handoff has a named reviewer and release decision.

Debrief

- Which agent produced the most persuasive but least controlled statement?
- Where did source authority matter more than answer fluency?
- Could two agents reach different but valid conclusions?
- What would you never allow Cowork to execute without an approval?